Matija Stepanic

Senior Software Engineer · Full-Stack & AI-Native Development
Zagreb, Croatia (CET, UTC+1)
Email: stepanic.matija@gmail.com
Web: https://stepanic.domovina.ai
GitHub: https://github.com/stepanic
LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/stepanic/
Toptal: https://www.toptal.com/resume/matija-stepanic
DOMOVINA.ai: https://domovina.ai

SUMMARY

Software engineer with 20 years of professional experience (since 2006) and 200+ delivered projects. MSc in Computer Science (FER, University of Zagreb). Founder & CEO of ITalk Ltd., Toptal Verified Expert, certified FlutterFlow Expert since 2022 with 50+ FlutterFlow consulting projects. Currently building AI-native products end-to-end: the DOMOVINA media-AI platform (RAG in ClickHouse, a public MCP server, Flutter, self-hosted Supabase) and PINKA on-chain crowdfunding. 4,949 GitHub contributions in the last year across 113 public repositories, working open-source-first with agentic AI tooling — 25B+ tokens processed with Claude Code, fully documented in a sourced public usage record. GitHub's raw counter reads 37,659, but 32,710 of those are automated commits publishing an open transcript corpus, so the corrected figure is the one quoted here.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Engineer
DOMOVINA.tv / DOMOVINA.ai | 06/2025 – present | Zagreb, Croatia — remote

- Designed and built the full platform solo using agentic AI development: Flutter app (web, iOS, Android, TV), self-hosted Supabase backend behind Kong on Coolify, and a Cloudflare edge layer — 4,949 GitHub contributions in a year across the ecosystem's code, separate from the 32,710 automated commits that publish the open transcript corpus.
- Built a 12-step media-ingestion pipeline (fetch.domovina.tv) that has processed 3,157 Croatian podcast episodes across 48 channels — ~2,990 hours of audio, 2,698 distinct speakers — into 144,294 semantic RAG chunks: Whisper.cpp on Metal and NVIDIA Canary on Colab GPUs for ASR, pyannote diarization, Gemini summarisation via multi-region Vertex AI rotation.
- Implemented RAG search over the archive — bge-m3 embeddings in ClickHouse (HNSW, ~10–50 ms) with PostgreSQL metadata — and a production MCP server (mcp.domovina.ai) with OAuth, per-client rate limiting and an audit dashboard, usable from Claude, ChatGPT and Cursor.
- Made RevenueCat the single billing system of record for the app across iOS, macOS, Android, Android TV and the web (RevenueCat Web Billing): one entitlement, a webhook mirroring entitlement state into Supabase Postgres behind RLS as the cross-platform source of truth, and optimistic unlock on mobile.
- Built pay.domovina.ai — SEPA EPC QR, Croatian HUB3 PDF417 and EIP-681 barcodes from a single form, with Safe 2/3 multisig routing of Monerium EURe on Gnosis Chain — plus a self-hosted SMS gateway, a catalogue of 901 Croatian football clubs and an interactive map of Croatia.

Co-Founder & Lead Engineer
PINKA Finance | 09/2025 – present | Remote

- Architected and shipped the bilingual (HR/EN) marketing site and campaign/checkout app: Next.js 14 static export served by Cloudflare Workers with D1, custom i18n engine with CLDR plural rules.
- Designed a Foundry smart-contract suite (factory + ERC20Permit token + crowdfund) on Gnosis Chain with four parallel investment paths — ERC677 transferAndCall, approve+invest, SEPA via Monerium webhook, Safe multisig — and shipped the app as a Safe App that also runs framed inside Safe{Wallet}.
- Independently verified a public on-chain fan-token lottery (modric-lottery-verify) with reproducible scripts over chain data.

Founder, CEO & Senior Software Engineer
ITalk Ltd. | 01/2016 – present | Zagreb, Croatia

- Worked as a FlutterFlow expert/consultant on 50+ projects: custom Flutter features, Firebase Cloud Functions integrations, published reusable open-source FlutterFlow components.
- Built a FlutterFlow identity-document scanning widget on top of BlinkID native SDKs, adopted by 1,119 different FlutterFlow projects.
- Developed FirePixy — photo-booth & event photo crowdsourcing platform: Node.js serverless backend (Firebase), Angular PWA, WPF photo-booth app integrated with the Canon EOS SDK.
- Led a team of 9 building ScanShop, a self-checkout retail platform: architecture and backend with NestJS + Parse Server, Angular PWA, native iOS/Android apps.
- Consulted for Microblink: server-side OCR bridge with API-key management for their SaaS, and a JavaScript web component + desktop-to-mobile handoff flow for document scanning.
- Built the backend for Tempo, an EU-funds project progress-tracking application (NestJS, Parse Server, Firebase), and a static-site platform (Angular + Scully + Flamelink CMS) powering multiple production sites since 2020.

Software Engineer
Freelance | 01/2006 – 01/2016 | Zagreb, Croatia

- Developed an internal CRM for membership and activities of a Croatian public organisation — in production since 2008 with ~1,500 active users.
- Built a custom CMS and website for a Croatian business news agency; co-founded and built the backend of Mobicon, a crowd-microphone application.
- Delivered 100+ commercial websites and internal tools (PHP, Java, Node.js, MySQL/PostgreSQL/MongoDB, AWS, Spring Boot, Yii).

SELECTED PROJECTS

DOMOVINA.tv / DOMOVINA.ai (Flutter, Dart, Python, Node.js, TypeScript, Supabase, PostgreSQL, ClickHouse, Whisper, Gemini, Cloudflare Workers, D1, Coolify, RAG, MCP, RevenueCat, Safe)

AI-native Croatian media platform of 30+ public repositories, built end-to-end by one engineer. An automated pipeline (Whisper.cpp on Metal, NVIDIA Canary on Colab GPUs, pyannote diarization, Gemini via multi-region Vertex AI) has processed 3,157 podcast episodes across 48 channels into 144,294 semantic RAG chunks, searchable through a public MCP server and a Flutter app that ships to web (WASM), iOS, Android and Android TV.

domovina-rag — RAG backend & public MCP server (TypeScript, Python, ClickHouse, PostgreSQL, bge-m3, MCP, Cloudflare R2, Coolify, Docker)

Self-hosted semantic-search backend over a Croatian podcast corpus: 144,294 RAG chunks from 3,157 episodes across 48 channels (~2,990 hours of audio, 2,698 distinct speakers), embedded with bge-m3 and stored in ClickHouse (HNSW vector index, ~10–50 ms queries) alongside PostgreSQL as the transactional source of truth. Exposed worldwide through a production MCP server, so Claude Desktop, Claude.ai, ChatGPT and Cursor can query the corpus as a native tool.

PINKA Finance (Next.js 14, TypeScript, Solidity, Foundry, Safe, Gnosis Chain, Monerium EURe, Supabase, Cloudflare, Tailwind)

Group-fundraising platform bridging bank transfers and on-chain money. Campaign & checkout app (Next.js 14) where backers pay by scanning a SEPA EPC QR code or on-chain via Monerium EURe on Gnosis Chain; Foundry smart-contract suite (PinkaFactory, PinkaToken, PinkaCrowdfund) supports four parallel investment paths — ERC677 transferAndCall, approve+invest, SEPA bank transfer via Monerium webhook, and Safe multisig.

flutter_certilia (Flutter, Dart, OAuth2, eID)

Open-source Flutter package for the Certilia Identity API — Croatian national eID (NIAS) authentication for Flutter apps, with documentation site. 110+ commits in the last year.

FirePixy (Node.js, Firebase, Angular, WPF, Canon EDSDK, Flutter)

Complete platform for photo booths and photo walls at weddings and community events: serverless Node.js backend on Firebase, Angular PWA for guests, WPF photo-booth application integrated with Canon EOS DSLR cameras and on-site printing, Flutter mobile apps.

ScanShop (NestJS, Parse Server, Firebase, Angular, Swift, Kotlin)

Self-checkout native mobile application for retail stores. Defined the architecture and built the backend (NestJS + Parse Server + Firebase) while leading a team of nine across backend, Angular PWA and native iOS/Android apps. Contributed improvements back to the open-source Parse Dashboard project.

FlutterFlow BlinkID Widget (FlutterFlow, Flutter, BlinkID, iOS, Android)

Custom FlutterFlow widget wrapping native iOS/Android identity-document scanning SDKs (BlinkID). Reads identity documents with the device camera and returns structured data into FlutterFlow action chains. Adopted by 1,119 different FlutterFlow projects.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript / JavaScript, Dart, SQL, Bash, PHP, Python, Solidity, Java, Kotlin, Swift, HTML / CSS / SCSS

Frameworks & Runtimes: Node.js, Flutter, FlutterFlow, Next.js / React, NestJS, Angular, Parse Server

Cloud & Infrastructure: Cloudflare (Workers, D1, R2, Pages), Firebase / GCP, Supabase (self-hosted), Docker / Coolify, AWS, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), PostgreSQL / MySQL / MongoDB

AI Engineering: Agentic development (Claude Code), RAG pipelines, MCP servers, LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI)

Web3 / Blockchain: EVM / Solidity, Safe smart accounts, On-chain verification

Other: Software architecture, Team leadership, OCR / identity documents (BlinkID), Payments (Stripe, stablecoins, SMS)

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science

University of Zagreb, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing (FER), 2013 – 2015

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Zagreb, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing (FER), 2009 – 2013

CERTIFICATIONS

- Toptal Verified Expert in Engineering, Toptal, 2022-02
- Certified FlutterFlow Expert, FlutterFlow, 2022-05

LANGUAGES

Croatian: Native; English: Full professional proficiency